



Dental ICP Soul Files

Central Region: Dallas-Fort Worth, Denver and San Antonio

Six ideal customer personas for independent dental practice owners, built as the foundation for the ReadTomato Soul File system and aligned with the Dental Outreach Sales Playbook.

Prepared for: Marshall, ReadTomato™

Date: September 2026

Internal use only

How to Use This Document

Each ICP Soul File describes a composite owner: a realistic, typical dentist built from workforce data, local market patterns and patient reviews. Treat them as starting points to test in real conversations, not rules about any individual.

What's inside

- **Market overview:** The three Central cities, their scores and where dental offices cluster.
- **Six ICP Soul Files:** A female and male owner for each city, with social, academic, professional, values and psychoanalytic profiles.
- **Pushback library:** Common objections to online marketing, Hot Take Engine and WebReno, with plain-English responses.
- **Soul File context layers:** Country, State, City and Industry PEST summaries with watch lists.
- **Outreach guardrails:** Rules that keep everything aligned with the Dental Outreach Sales Playbook.

Score legend

Score	What it measures
Opportunity	How attractive the persona is as a target: numbers, growth, wealth and openness to outside help.
Message fit	How easily ReadTomato's offer speaks to their core drive without triggering their defenses.
Hot Take Engine fit	How naturally the monthly interview and content model suits them.
WebReno fit	How naturally a website content renovation suits them.

Basic instructions for the team

- **Tag every prospect at Stage 0:** Pick the persona that fits best based on city, owner gender, practice style and website.
- Use the persona as a starting guess only: The problem the dentist actually describes decides the product.
- **Never use the context in outreach:** Sports, local events and politics are here so you understand the person. They never appear in messages.
- **Log real language:** Record the exact phrases prospects use. After 30 to 60 days, replace the composite phrases with real ones and adjust the scores.

Market Overview

Cities were ranked by metro population as a stand-in for dental search demand, since dental searches are overwhelmingly local. Clusters are the areas where dental offices bunch up most, based on a Google Maps sweep of each city.

City	Score	Busiest dental clusters (highest opportunity first)
Dallas-Fort Worth	82%	Frisco (92%), Plano Legacy Drive corridor (88%), Uptown Dallas (80%), North Dallas Preston Road corridor (78%), Fort Worth west side and Hulen (75%), Las Colinas and Irving (72%)
Denver	76%	Denver Tech Center and Greenwood Village (82%), Highlands Ranch (80%), Cherry Creek and Glendale (78%), LoDo and Riverfront (70%), Southlands in southeast Aurora (68%)
San Antonio	77%	Stone Oak (84%), Medical Center (76%), Alamo Heights and Broadway (72%)

Central Region overall: 78%

Opportunity scores weigh competition (crowded areas need marketing more), independents vs. chains (independents make their own buying decisions) and local wealth and growth.

Persona summary

Persona	City	Opportunity	Message fit	Lead product
The Growth Builder (M)	Dallas-Fort Worth	85%	85%	Hot Take Engine
The Polished Operator (F)	Dallas-Fort Worth	80%	82%	WebReno, then HTE
The Wellness Purist (F)	Denver	80%	80%	Hot Take Engine
The Hometown Anchor (M)	San Antonio	76%	74%	WebReno
The Independent Craftsman (M)	Denver	74%	72%	Hot Take Engine
The Next-Gen Heir (F)	San Antonio	72%	76%	WebReno

National facts behind every persona

- **Women:** Nearly 2 in 5 US dentists were female in 2024 (39%, up from 16% in 2001). About half of dentists 35 and under are women.
- **Ownership:** Men still own more practices. The gap is 16 percentage points early in careers and shrinks to 8 by late career, so the female owner you meet is often mid-career or later.
- **Income:** General dentist income fell from \$267,000 in 2010 to \$210,000 in 2024, which makes owners more open to anything that grows revenue.
- **Chains:** DSO affiliation reached 16.1% nationally, with the fastest growth in Colorado.
- **Degree:** Every dentist holds a DDS or DMD, the same four-year doctorate earned after a bachelor's degree. Specialists add a 2 to 6 year residency.

The shared dental psyche

- **Identity fused with clinical skill:** Self-worth is often tied to clinical performance, and perfectionism makes it hard to lead and delegate.
- **Lonely at the top:** Apart from an assistant, the dentist is often alone all day. Competition with other dentists deepens the isolation.
- **The golden cage:** A practice that depends entirely on the owner can feel like a trap.
- **The PPO trap:** Most owners stay in insurance networks longer than they want because leaving feels risky.
- **Agency trauma:** “I’ve been burned before” is the most common objection to any marketing partner.

ICP SOUL FILE 1 OF 6

The Polished Operator

Dallas-Fort Worth | Female owner

Where they cluster: Frisco, Plano (Legacy Drive corridor), North Dallas and Uptown

Opportunity	Message fit	Hot Take Engine fit	WebReno fit
80%	82%	80%	88%

The question they're secretly asking

"Can I have it all without anything slipping?"

Snapshot

- **Age:** 36 to 50.
- **Path:** Bought or opened her practice after 5 to 10 years as an associate.
- **Life:** Often a mom balancing ownership with a busy family schedule.
- **Brand:** The practice mirrors her personal standards and taste: beautiful office, comfort menus, warm tone.

Social Profile

- Pilates, barre and boutique fitness.
- School and youth sports parent. Church involvement is common in the suburbs.
- Charity galas and women's networking groups.
- Very active on Instagram.

Academic Profile

- **Degree:** DDS or DMD, often from Texas A&M College of Dentistry (Dallas) or UT Health San Antonio.
- **Extra credentials:** Invisalign certification, cosmetic training and pediatric-friendly care.
- **Associations:** Some belong to the American Association of Women Dentists.

Professional Profile

- **Continuing education:** Focused on cosmetic work, clear aligners and patient experience.
- **E-learning:** High interest. Short on-demand courses and live webinars fit around family life.
- **Management style:** Progressive. Team-culture focused, invests in staff happiness, offers flexible schedules and usually pushes for online booking and text reminders.
- **Texas rule:** 24 CE hours every two years. Practice-finance courses don't count, so any business learning she takes is by choice.

Values Stance

Moderate. Fiscally practical and socially middle-of-the-road. Cares deeply about reputation and reviews.

Psychoanalytic Profile

- **Self-image:** I built something beautiful and I run it well.

- **Core drive:** Recognition as a CEO, not just a clinician. Proof her practice is the best in its area.
- **Core fear:** Something slipping while she's pulled between home and practice. Not being taken seriously as the owner (women owners report being mistaken for the hygienist or assistant).
- **Defenses:** Over-functioning (it's faster if I do it myself), perfectionism about her brand and carrying every role at once.
- **Positive triggers:** Being treated as the decision-maker, polished work, content that sounds like her, respect for her team.
- **Negative triggers:** Condescension, "Is the doctor available?", templated work, anything that adds work for her front desk.
- **Decision style:** Researches thoroughly, checks with peers, decides with data then gut. Wants a trial or a clear exit.

Language

Typical phrases

- "I just want it to look and sound like us."
- "Our patients expect a certain experience."
- "We're not a mill."
- "Is this going to create more work for my front desk?"
- "My team is like family."
- "I don't have time to babysit a vendor."

Jargon (recognize it, don't use it)

patient experience, comfort menu, Invisalign starts, case acceptance, Google reviews, new patient numbers, hygiene schedule

Words that repel them

hustle, crush it, dominate, fear-based urgency, bro-style marketing

ReadTomato Fit

- **Lead product:** WebReno, then Hot Take Engine (Classic Problem A).
- **Top pushback:** "Will this create work for my team?"
- **Meeting-stage reframe:** Your voice, polished, with no extra work for your front desk.

Outreach Playbook Overlay

- **Salutation:** First name is fine after connecting.
- **[SERVICE] for Stage 2:** Invisalign or cosmetic dentistry.
- **Touch 2 angle:** New families moving into the area and searching for a family dentist.
- **Buying signal to watch:** "What would it look like?"
- **Human Conversation example:** "Yeah, your office looks great in the photos. The website just doesn't show that yet. Who handles the site for you guys?"

ICP SOUL FILE 2 OF 6

The Growth Builder

Dallas-Fort Worth | Male owner

Where they cluster: Frisco, Plano, North Dallas and the Fort Worth west side

Opportunity	Message fit	Hot Take Engine fit	WebReno fit
85%	85%	88%	78%

The question they're secretly asking

"Am I winning, and am I about to get played?"

Snapshot

- **Age:** 38 to 55.
- **Practice:** Owns one to three locations, sometimes with a partner.
- **Mindset:** Thinks like a CEO. May be weighing a chain buyout offer or planning to expand.

Social Profile

- Golf and country club membership.
- College football (Texas A&M, UT, SMU or TCU). Cowboys and Mavericks season tickets.
- Church, Rotary and the Chamber of Commerce.
- Hunting or lake weekends.
- Business and dental podcasts on the commute.

Academic Profile

- **Degree:** DDS or DMD from Texas A&M or UT Health, or a transplant from another state.
- **Business:** Some hold an MBA or take business courses.
- **Extra credentials:** Often pursues the AGD Fellowship (FAGD) or implant training.

Professional Profile

- **Continuing education:** Implants, same-day crowns and sedation. High-revenue skills.
- **E-learning:** Moderate to high, but it must pay off. Likes business masterminds and clinical programs such as Spear.
- **Management style:** Systems and numbers driven. Tracks production, new patients per month and ad spend. Progressive on technology and marketing, more traditional on team structure.

Values Stance

Moderate to conservative. Pro-business and low-regulation. Often skeptical of agencies after being burned before.

Psychoanalytic Profile

- **Self-image:** I'm a business owner who happens to be a dentist.

- **Core drive:** Scale, wealth and status. The next location, a bigger exit value, beating the chain down the road.
- **Core fear:** Being a sucker again. Plateauing while chains outspend him. Privately, exhaustion and the “golden cage” of a business that depends on him.
- **Defenses:** Hiding behind numbers, skepticism as armor and blaming the front desk or the last agency when things break.
- **Positive triggers:** ROI math, peer benchmarks, speed, exclusivity and month-to-month terms.
- **Negative triggers:** Vague metrics, “brand awareness,” “trust the process,” long contracts and slow sales cycles.
- **Decision style:** Fast once the math works. Checks Dentaltown and dentist Facebook groups before trusting a vendor.

Language

Typical phrases

- “What's my ROI?”
- “Show me the numbers.”
- “I've been burned before.”
- “How many new patients a month are we talking?”
- “The chains are eating my lunch.”
- “Month-to-month or I'm out.”

Jargon (recognize it, don't use it)

production vs. collections, overhead percentage, doctor production per day, new patient flow, cost per acquisition, full-arch cases, same-day dentistry, EBITDA, the multiple

Words that repel them

journey, storytelling, awareness, anything without a number attached

ReadTomato Fit

- **Lead product:** Hot Take Engine (Classic Problem B).
- **Top pushback:** “What's my ROI and am I locked in?”
- **Meeting-stage reframe:** Here's what new patients have to be worth to cover this.

Outreach Playbook Overlay

- **Salutation:** First name is fine after connecting.
- **[SERVICE] for Stage 2:** Dental implants.
- **Touch 2 angle:** How competing practices show up for implant searches in his area.
- **Buying signal to watch:** “What does it cost?” or “How many patients?”
- **Pacing note:** He may move through the stages faster, but the early messages stay the same. Money only comes up when he asks.
- **Human Conversation example:** “Fair question. It really depends on what you're trying to grow. Is it more implants or more new patients overall?”

ICP SOUL FILE 3 OF 6

The Wellness Purist

Denver | Female owner

Where they cluster: Cherry Creek, LoDo and the Denver Tech Center

Opportunity	Message fit	Hot Take Engine fit	WebReno fit
80%	80%	90%	72%

The question they're secretly asking

"Can I grow without betraying who I am?"

Snapshot

- **Age:** 34 to 50.
- **Practice:** Owns a 1 to 2 provider practice.
- **Why Denver:** Chose the city for the lifestyle as much as the career.

Social Profile

- Yoga, trail running, skiing and hiking.
- Farmers markets and local coffee shops. Sustainability-minded.
- Instagram and podcasts. Follows wellness and holistic health creators.

Academic Profile

- **Degree:** DDS or DMD from the University of Colorado School of Dental Medicine or an out-of-state school (Creighton, Nebraska, Midwestern, Roseman or a coastal program).
- **Interests:** Preventive care, gum health, airway and sleep dentistry and the links between oral and whole-body health.

Professional Profile

- **Continuing education:** Holistic or biological dentistry courses, airway and sleep apnea training, conservative treatment philosophies.
- **E-learning:** High. A lifelong learner comfortable with online study groups and live webinars.
- **Management style:** Very progressive. Values-led culture, transparent pricing and possibly moving to fee-for-service. Adds personal touches like therapy dogs and calm music.
- **Colorado rule:** 30 CE hours every two years, with up to 15 by home study.

Values Stance

Progressive. Ethics, patient education and sustainability are central to her identity.

Psychoanalytic Profile

- **Self-image:** Healer and educator, never a salesperson.
- **Core drive:** Alignment between her values and her business. Meaningful work and patients who "get it."

- **Core fear:** Looking greedy or salesy. Selling out to private equity. Compromising care because of insurance limits.
- **Defenses:** Moral distancing (I don't do marketing, I educate), retreating into research and sometimes undercharging to avoid feeling greedy.
- **Positive triggers:** Authenticity, sustainability, science-backed education and full transparency, including about any AI use.
- **Negative triggers:** Hype, free-whitening promos, fake urgency, before-and-after gimmicks and anything that feels manipulative.
- **Decision style:** Slow and values-first. Reads everything and wants to know the people behind the agency.

Language

Typical phrases

- "I don't want to sound salesy."
- "It has to feel authentic."
- "We practice conservatively."
- "It's about whole-body health."
- "We're going out of network and I don't want to lose my people."
- "I refuse to become a mill."

Jargon (recognize it, don't use it)

minimally invasive, conservative dentistry, airway and sleep, oral-systemic link, biological or holistic, preventive, patient-centered, FFS, membership plan

Words that repel them

leads, conversions, dominate your market, funnel

ReadTomato Fit

- **Lead product:** Hot Take Engine (Classic Problem B).
- **Top pushback:** "I don't want AI or anything salesy."
- **Meeting-stage reframe:** Education in your own words. You approve everything.

Outreach Playbook Overlay

- **Salutation:** First name is fine after connecting.
- **[SERVICE] for Stage 2:** Preventive or conservative dentistry.
- **Touch 2 angle:** What local patients are asking about gum health and prevention.
- **Buying signal to watch:** "Who writes it?"
- **Honesty note:** She is the persona most likely to notice an AI avatar video. Say "I put together a quick video" rather than "I made."
- **Human Conversation example:** "Totally get that. Nothing goes out without you seeing it. What do your patients ask you about most?"

ICP SOUL FILE 4 OF 6

The Independent Craftsman

Denver | Male owner

Where they cluster: Denver Tech Center, Highlands Ranch and Cherry Creek

Opportunity	Message fit	Hot Take Engine fit	WebReno fit
74%	72%	82%	65%

The question they're secretly asking

"Will I be the last real independent, and does anyone value that?"

Snapshot

- **Age:** 38 to 58.
- **Practice:** Owns an established practice.
- **Pressure:** Has likely turned down, or is weighing, a private equity offer.

Social Profile

- Skiing, mountain biking, fly fishing and hunting.
- Craft beer and Broncos games. Family weekends in the mountains.
- Low-key on social media. Prefers LinkedIn and dental forums over Instagram.

Academic Profile

- **Degree:** DDS or DMD from CU, Creighton or Nebraska.
- **Extra credentials:** Often pursues advanced restorative training at well-known private institutes such as Kois, Pankey or Dawson.

Professional Profile

- **Continuing education:** Precision restorative work, implants, occlusion (how the bite fits together) and full-mouth cases.
- **E-learning:** Moderate. Values hands-on and live courses more than video.
- **Management style:** Craftsman-focused. Proud of quality and slow to change systems. Progressive on clinical technology, traditional on marketing.

Values Stance

Moderate. Independent-minded, protective of private practice and wary of both corporate dentistry and big government.

Psychoanalytic Profile

- **Self-image:** Master craftsman. His work is his signature.
- **Core drive:** Mastery, autonomy and a legacy of quality.
- **Core fear:** Becoming a cog in a corporate machine. Being commoditized. Quietly, what happens to the practice when he retires.

- **Defenses:** Retreating into clinical detail, contempt for marketing (good work markets itself) and withdrawal (I just want to do dentistry).
- **Positive triggers:** Respect for his craft, precision, peer credibility and attracting patients who value comprehensive care.
- **Negative triggers:** Cheap promos, being lumped in with chains, marketing buzzwords and volume talk.
- **Decision style:** Deliberate and skeptical. Wants peer references. Once he trusts you, he's very loyal.

Language

Typical phrases

- “Good dentistry sells itself.”
- “I'm not interested in volume.”
- “I want the right patients, not more patients.”
- “I've had three DSO offers this year.”
- “I just want to do dentistry.”
- “We do comprehensive care here.”

Jargon (recognize it, don't use it)

occlusion, comprehensive exam, full-mouth rehab, restorative, case presentation, lab bill, complete dentistry, Kois, Dawson, Pankey

Words that repel them

growth hacks, viral, engagement, cheap, specials

ReadTomato Fit

- **Lead product:** Hot Take Engine (Classic Problem B).
- **Top pushback:** “Good dentistry sells itself.”
- **Meeting-stage reframe:** Your expertise attracts patients who value complete care.

Outreach Playbook Overlay

- **Salutation:** Keep “Dr.” until he signs off with his first name.
- **[SERVICE] for Stage 2:** Crowns or full-mouth restoration.
- **Touch 2 angle:** How comprehensive-care practices show up in search compared with chains.
- **Buying signal to watch:** “What else did you find?”
- **Touch 3 note:** Keep the blog on patient questions, not clinical claims. He'll judge the clinical accuracy harshly.
- **Human Conversation example:** “Makes sense. You're not trying to get busier, just get the right people in. Are most of your big cases coming from referrals right now?”

ICP SOUL FILE 5 OF 6

The Next-Gen Heir

San Antonio | Female owner

Where they cluster: Medical Center, Stone Oak and Alamo Heights

Opportunity	Message fit	Hot Take Engine fit	WebReno fit
72%	76%	72%	90%

The question they're secretly asking

"Am I worthy of the name on the door?"

Snapshot

- **Age:** 32 to 48.
- **Path:** Took over or joined a parent's or mentor's long-running practice.
- **Balance:** Respecting the legacy while modernizing it.

Social Profile

- Church and family gatherings.
- Fiesta events and community volunteering.
- Spurs games.
- Active on Facebook and Instagram for community connection. Often bilingual.

Academic Profile

- **Degree:** DDS from UT Health San Antonio School of Dentistry.
- **Extra training:** Some complete a one-year general residency (AEGD or GPR) or add pediatric training.

Professional Profile

- **Continuing education:** Pediatric-friendly care, clear aligners and practice modernization.
- **E-learning:** High. She's the one pushing the practice toward new systems.
- **Management style:** Progressive inside a traditional practice. Wants online booking, texting and a modern website without alienating long-time patients or the older generation.

Values Stance

Moderate. Family and faith oriented, open-minded on business methods.

Psychoanalytic Profile

- **Self-image:** Steward of a legacy and the one who will carry it forward.
- **Core drive:** Earning respect from long-time staff, loyal patients and her parent or mentor.
- **Core fear:** Being seen as "the daughter" rather than the leader. Changing too fast and losing loyal patients. Disappointing the founder.
- **Defenses:** People-pleasing with veteran staff, incrementalism and needing consensus before moving.

- **Positive triggers:** Respect for the legacy, community focus, bilingual content, family values and help bringing the team along.
- **Negative triggers:** Rip-and-replace pitches, disrespect toward the founding dentist and slick corporate energy.
- **Decision style:** Collaborative. Involves the office manager and often her parent. Needs simple proof points she can share internally.

Language

Typical phrases

- “My dad built this practice.”
- “Our patients have been with us for 20 years.”
- “I want to bring us into this century without scaring anybody.”
- “Our front desk has always done it this way.”
- “We need everything in Spanish too.”
- “How do we get young families without losing the grandparents?”

Jargon (recognize it, don't use it)

recall, unscheduled treatment, online scheduling, text reminders, TRICARE and FEDVIP (military dental insurance), CHIP and Medicaid for kids

Words that repel them

disrupt, overhaul, outdated (it feels like an insult to the founder)

ReadTomato Fit

- **Lead product:** WebReno (Classic Problem A).
- **Top pushback:** “I can't change too fast.”
- **Meeting-stage reframe:** Modernize the website first. The practice stays the same.

Outreach Playbook Overlay

- **Salutation:** First name is fine after connecting.
- **[SERVICE] for Stage 2:** Family dentist or Spanish-speaking dentist.
- **Touch 2 angle:** Young families searching in Spanish or looking for online booking.
- **Buying signal to watch:** “Let me run it by my office manager.” This is a real signal, not a brush-off.
- **Human Conversation example:** “That's smart. No point changing things that are working. What does your office manager think of the website?”

ICP SOUL FILE 6 OF 6

The Hometown Anchor

San Antonio | Male owner

Where they cluster: Medical Center, Stone Oak and Alamo Heights

Opportunity	Message fit	Hot Take Engine fit	WebReno fit
76%	74%	60%	85%

The question they're secretly asking

"Will what I built still matter when I'm gone?"

Snapshot

- **Age:** 45 to 65.
- **Tenure:** 15 to 30 years at the same location.
- **Horizon:** Thinking about succession and his legacy.

Social Profile

- Church leadership and Rotary or Lions Club.
- Hunting and ranch weekends in the Hill Country.
- Spurs and high school football.
- Fiesta and military community ties. Many are veterans.
- Minimal personal social media. Relies on word of mouth.

Academic Profile

- **Degree:** DDS from UT Health San Antonio, or a military-trained dentist who settled in the city after service.
- **Associations:** Long-time member of local dental societies and study clubs.

Professional Profile

- **Continuing education:** Steady clinical CE, often live and in person with peers.
- **E-learning:** Low to moderate. Does what's required and prefers in-person learning.
- **Management style:** Traditional and relationship-based. Loyal staff who have been there for decades. Behind on digital marketing and knows it.

Values Stance

Conservative. Faith, family, community and service.

Psychoanalytic Profile

- **Self-image:** Community pillar, family doctor and servant-leader.
- **Core drive:** Legacy, loyalty, being needed and a dignified transition.
- **Core fear:** Irrelevance. Being left behind by technology. Practice value shrinking before he sells. Selling to a chain that ruins what he built.

- **Defenses:** Denial (we've always done fine on word of mouth), minimizing how much younger families expect online booking and loyalty to underperforming old vendors.
- **Positive triggers:** A personal relationship, a handshake feel, respect for his years of service, faith and community references, veteran connections.
- **Negative triggers:** Pushy young sales reps, tech jargon, being talked down to and complex contracts.
- **Decision style:** Relationship-first and slow. Prefers a phone call to an email. Often hands details to his office manager or spouse, so win them over too.

Language

Typical phrases

- "I've been here 25 years."
- "We've always done fine on word of mouth."
- "My patients are like family."
- "I don't do the internet stuff. Talk to my office manager."
- "I'm not trying to get rich. I just want to take care of my people."
- "What happens to this place when I retire?"

Jargon (recognize it, don't use it)

the schedule (the book), recall cards, production, my team, associate, transition, buyout

Words that repel them

AI-powered, omnichannel, funnel, SaaS, anything that sounds like Silicon Valley

ReadTomato Fit

- **Lead product:** WebReno (Classic Problem A).
- **Top pushback:** "We do fine on word of mouth."
- **Meeting-stage reframe:** Protect your reputation online so the next generation finds you.

Outreach Playbook Overlay

- **Salutation:** Keep "Dr." until he signs off with his first name.
- **[SERVICE] for Stage 2:** Family dentist or emergency dentist.
- **Touch 2 angle:** How the practice appears when people search the neighborhood.
- **Buying signal to watch:** "Talk to my office manager." He's handing off details, not saying no.
- **Human Conversation example:** "Twenty-five years is a long time. That kind of reputation should show up when people look you up. Is someone on your team handling that stuff?"

Pushback Library

Use these once the prospect is in real conversation. None of this belongs in the early touches.

Online marketing in general

What they say	What's behind it	Plain-English response
"I've been burned by agencies before."	Agency trauma	"Most dentists we talk to have been. What went wrong last time?" Then show the difference instead of asking for trust.
"I don't want to be locked into a contract."	Fear of marketing handcuffs	Be clear about terms when they ask. Dodging confirms the fear.
"We get patients from word of mouth."	Pride in reputation	"Word of mouth happens on Google and ChatGPT now. Referrals look you up before they call."
"I can't tell if it's working."	Vague past reports	Agree on 2 or 3 measures up front, such as new patient calls, rankings and booked appointments.
"My patients only care about insurance."	The PPO trap belief	"Content is how you attract patients who choose you, not just your network."
"I don't have time."	Overload	"It's one conversation a month. We handle the rest."
"AI content is junk."	Reasonable skepticism	"That's why every article starts from your interview, not a template."
"Is this compliant?"	Fear of the state board	WebReno reviews compliance language. The dentist approves any clinical claims.
"The chains outspend me."	Feeling outgunned	"You can't outspend them, but you can out-expert them."

Hot Take Engine

Pushback	Response
"An hour a month is too much."	That hour replaces 8 articles and 16 social posts they'd never write. An associate or office manager can cover some topics.
"I don't want AI writing clinical content."	The content comes from their words and they approve clinical claims before anything goes live.
"It'll sound like every other dentist."	The interview captures their opinions and stories. Hot takes are the opposite of generic.
"I don't want strong opinions online."	A hot take can simply be a clear, helpful point of view. Example: "Why we don't push deep cleanings."
"Blogs are dead."	Generic blogs are. Content structured for AI answers is what survives.
"I don't have anything interesting to say."	"You answer patient questions all day. That's the content."
"Who posts the social content?"	Be exact about what's delivered and what the practice has to do.

WebReno

Pushback	Response
"I just paid for a new website."	WebReno isn't a redesign. It cleans up the content that's working against them.
"My web company or DSO controls the site."	Work alongside their provider or deliver content they can hand off.
"Will this hurt my rankings?"	The goal is removing content that's already dragging rankings down. Start with the audit.
"My website is fine."	The audit answers this. Most owners find problems they didn't know about.
"What does AI visibility mean?"	"When someone asks ChatGPT for the best dentist near them, are you in the answer?" Show them live.
"Why do I need this and Hot Take Engine?"	New content on a messy site is like new art in a house with a leaking roof. Fix the foundation first.

Soul File Context Layers

Context only

These layers help the team and the Hot Take Engine understand each persona's world. Sports, local events and politics never appear in outreach messages. Only use a fact in a Touch 2 message when it's verified and genuinely relevant to that practice.

Country Soul: United States (Marketing climate: 70%)

Real passions and identity: Polarized, cautious and heading into midterm elections on November 3, 2026. America's 250th birthday is a year-long theme.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Federal health leadership is skeptical of fluoride. Utah and Florida banned community water fluoridation while the ADA and CDC still support it. Federal budget changes are shifting Medicaid costs to states.
Economic	Tariffs and soft consumer spending in some cities. Dental benefit enrollment is declining.
Social	Trust in health advice is split along political lines.
Technological	AI is moving into everyday dental software, including AI diagnostics.

Watch list: Midterm results, CDC and EPA fluoride actions, Medicaid work requirement rollout, tariffs on dental supplies.

State Soul: Texas (Marketing climate: 82%)

Real passions and identity: Fierce independence, Friday night football, faith and family, BBQ, rodeo and pride in no state income tax. Owning your own business is admired.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Gov. Abbott faces Gina Hinojosa. Ken Paxton faces James Talarico for US Senate, and polling shows an unusually competitive race. Paxton is a vocal fluoride opponent. New law SB 1318 limits noncompetes for dentists to one year and five miles, with a buyout capped at one year's pay.
Economic	Business-friendly, fast population growth and heavy corporate relocation. Insurance-heavy patient base.
Social	Constant new residents. Large Hispanic population, especially in San Antonio. Strong church and community networks.
Technological	Texas AI governance law (TRAIGA) took effect in January 2026 and is lighter-touch than Colorado's.

Watch list: November 3 results for Governor, Senate and AG. Fluoride bills in the 2027 session. Court challenges to SB 1318.

State Soul: Colorado (Marketing climate: 72%)

Real passions and identity: Outdoors as identity, craft beer, sustainability, fitness culture and many lifestyle-driven transplants.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Gov. Polis is term-limited. Nominees are Democrat Phil Weiser and Republican Victor Marx. Republicans haven't won statewide since 2016. The state licenses dental therapists.
Economic	Medicaid now takes about a third of the general fund. The 2026-27 budget cut most Medicaid provider rates by 2% and capped adult dental benefits at \$3,000. Colorado leads the nation in chain dentistry growth.
Social	Educated, wellness-driven consumers who reward authenticity. An aging population is raising implant demand.
Technological	The Colorado AI Act, the first broad US law on high-risk AI including healthcare, was set for June 30, 2026 with ongoing debate. Check current status.

Watch list: Governor results, AI Act amendments or delays, next Medicaid budget, dental therapist scope.

City Soul: Dallas-Fort Worth (Marketing climate: 85%)

Real passions and identity: Cowboys, Rangers, Mavericks and Stars. The State Fair of Texas. Big, bold and growth-obsessed. Dallas is polished; Fort Worth is cowboys and culture.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Dallas leans progressive. Collin County leans center-right but is getting more competitive. Tarrant County is closely split.
Economic	Nine World Cup matches in Arlington and Universal Kids Resort opening in Frisco in summer 2026. The PGA Championship comes to Frisco in May 2027. Corporate relocations keep bringing insured families.
Social	Young families arriving monthly. Diverse, status-conscious suburbs where reviews and aesthetics matter.
Technological	Patients expect online booking, texting and digital scans.

Watch list: Collin County election results, corporate relocations, Frisco growth projects.

City Soul: Denver (Marketing climate: 73%)

Real passions and identity: Mountains every weekend, Red Rocks, craft breweries, Nuggets and Broncos, dog-friendly everything and a work-to-live culture.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Strongly progressive city. South suburbs are moderate to conservative.
Economic	The city closed a \$200 million 2026 budget gap with 169 layoffs. Sales tax revenue growth flattened to 0%, a sign that elective dental spending may be under pressure.
Social	Many transplants with no family dentist loyalty. Highly educated and skeptical of upselling.
Technological	Tech-savvy population and stricter state AI rules.

Watch list: City budget adoption, sales tax trends, private equity deals in the metro.

City Soul: San Antonio (Marketing climate: 76%)

Real passions and identity: The Spurs and Victor Wembanyama, Fiesta every April, Military City USA, Tejano heritage and multigenerational family loyalty.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Mayor Gina Ortiz Jones has pushed for a new vote on the city's \$489 million share of the Project Marvel arena district. The city leans moderate to progressive; Stone Oak and Alamo Heights lean conservative.
Economic	The mayor describes an affordability crisis made harder by persistent poverty. Military families on federal insurance. More premium spending in Stone Oak and Alamo Heights.
Social	Hispanic-majority city where bilingual care is an advantage. Faith and community events drive word of mouth.
Technological	Slower adoption. Extended-hours chains are winning younger families on convenience.

Watch list: Project Marvel vote, November elections, city budget and flood control spending.

Industry Soul: US Dentistry (Marketing climate: 80%)

Real passions and identity: Pride in clinical craft and doing right by patients. Loyalty to private practice among older owners. A pull toward work-life balance among younger dentists.

PEST	What matters for a dental owner
Political	Fluoride fights. State laws targeting private equity in dentistry. A federal bill on self-funded dental plans. Medicaid pressure on adult dental benefits.
Economic	Patient spending is up 9% over pre-pandemic levels, but flat reimbursements and rising costs are squeezing margins. Many owners want to drop low-paying networks but don't act. Chain consolidation has cooled since its 2022 peak.
Social	Hygienists remain extremely hard to hire. The workforce is getting younger and more female. Patients fear upselling and reward honesty.
Technological	Large chains are rolling out AI at scale. A wave of cyberattacks is hitting dental organizations. Private practices lean on relationships while chains lean on automation.

Watch list: ADA quarterly economic reports, DSO deal activity, CDT code changes, cyberattack headlines, AI regulation.

Outreach Guardrails

These rules keep the ICP work aligned with the Dental Outreach Sales Playbook.

Never in outreach

- **Product names early:** AI, Hot Take Engine, WebReno or ReadTomato in the opening touches.
- **Playbook banned words:** gift, free offer, lead magnet, sample, automation, bots, funnel, sales system and “I’m not trying to sell you anything.”
- **Persona repel words:** See the “Words that repel them” list in each Soul File.
- **Local clichés:** Sports, weather, local events or any political reference.
- **Dentist jargon:** Recognize it so you can follow the conversation, then reply in plain words.
- **Manufactured loss:** Never claim lost patients without a verified observation.

Every message must

- Use natural contractions, short sentences and one idea at a time.
- Contain no em dashes and no Oxford commas.
- Still make sense if the prospect doesn’t watch the video.
- Back any gap or loss with something the rep can actually show.

Honesty and trust

- **MyChatSales:** Never let the system claim to be a specific human. If a prospect asks whether they’re talking to a real person, answer honestly. Confirm disclosure and texting consent rules with a lawyer.
- **Video wording:** Say “I put together a quick video” rather than “I made a quick video” when using HeyGen. Be straightforward if asked how it was made.
- **Touch 3 blog:** Keep it on patient questions and local topics, not clinical claims. Explain that the real version is built from the dentist’s own interview. Recommend they review anything before posting.
- **Salutation:** Keep “Dr.” for the Hometown Anchor and the Independent Craftsman until they sign off with a first name.

Fluoride

Avoid it in outreach unless the dentist raises it. It’s politically charged and can land badly with both progressive and conservative personas.

Sources and Notes

Key sources used to build these Soul Files. Figures marked as estimates in earlier research (such as some metro populations) were not independently verified.

- ADA Health Policy Institute, The U.S. Dentist Workforce: Update 2025, and Practice Ownership Trends in Dentistry (June 2025).
- DentistryIQ summary of the 2025 ADA HPI workforce report (income, DSO affiliation).
- Texas State Board of Dental Examiners and Spear Education (Texas CE requirements).
- Colorado Division of Professions and Occupations and NetCE (Colorado CE requirements).
- **Texas SB 1318 coverage:** Greenberg Traurig, Jackson Lewis and National Law Review.
- **Texas 2026 election coverage:** FOX 4, Texas Tribune and Texas Southern University polling.
- **Colorado 2026 governor race and budget:** Colorado Sun, CPR and Summit Daily.
- **Colorado AI Act:** Clark Hill, Reed Smith and PYMNTS.
- **Denver budget:** CBS News Colorado and Axios Denver.
- **San Antonio Project Marvel:** KSAT, San Antonio Report and San Antonio Current.
- **Dallas-Fort Worth 2026 events:** Community Impact, Family eGuide and TravelPulse.
- **Industry outlook:** Benesch DSO newsletters, Planet DDS 2026 Outlook and Dentaltown ADA Q4 report summary.
- **Dentist psychology:** Bulletproof Dental Practice podcast, Dental Update and industry coverage of stress and perfectionism.
- ReadTomato.com product pages and the ReadTomato Dental Outreach Sales Playbook.
- Google Maps listings for dental office clusters in each city (September 2026).

A note on the personas

Gender, age, values stance and language patterns are composites based on published data and observed patterns. They describe tendencies, not individuals. Validate them against real conversations and update the scores every 30 to 60 days.